SPIRALWEB STEWARDSHIP ASSOCIATION · MARCH 2026
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Constitutional Ground

Stewardship, support, and the pathway from red to green

> Function of this document
>
> This text states the constitutional orientation of Spiralweb Stewardship Association. It does not replace the association's formal bylaws. It sets out the stewardship principles, support logic, and red-to-green discipline that inform the association's purpose, governance, and public direction.

Preamble

We write this document at a threshold.

Not at the beginning of the work, but at the point where long-carried practice now requires lawful form, public language, and shared protection.

Spiralweb Stewardship Association arose from years of field practice, observation, documentation, governance development, and repeated attempts to find forms of stewardship that do not violate life in the moment they seek to organize it. The association now serves as the legal and institutional vessel through which that work can be carried more clearly, more lawfully, and with greater continuity.

Again and again, the same lesson returned: that land cannot be healed through hidden human depletion; that stewardship cannot be sustained through confusion; that governance cannot remain trustworthy when streams are mixed; and that support loses its integrity when it becomes a path to control.

This constitutional ground is therefore not only about money. It concerns the conditions under which support can remain life-serving, and the discipline by which movement from red to green becomes possible without denial, inflation, or extraction.

We use the language of red, yellow, green, and unknown as a discipline of honest reading.

Red names overload, depletion, distortion, ecological stress, hidden conflict, or loss of viable continuity.

Yellow names adjustment, restraint, clarification, and truthful rereading.

Green does not mean perfection. It means sufficient coherence for land, stewards, and governance to continue without concealment.

Unknown names insufficient evidence or standpoint for a responsible reading. It remains distinct from yellow and green; section V describes its practical implications.

For this reason, Spiralweb Stewardship Association is constituted as a bounded stewardship body: a lawful vessel for receiving support, carrying responsibility, and protecting the viability of land, stewards, and governance conditions together.

This is the constitutional ground from which the rest follows.

I. What We Have Learned

We have learned that not all growth is a sign of health.

A field may appear to expand while its soil is weakening. A project may look active while its stewards are becoming exhausted. A governance structure may seem functional while roles, expectations, and decisions are becoming unclear.

For this reason, we do not read stewardship through a single metric. We read it through distinct but related streams.

One stream concerns **land and ecology**: soil, water, biodiversity, regeneration, and the material conditions of life.

One stream concerns **steward viability**: time, energy, livelihood, fatigue, continuity, and the real carrying capacity of the human beings involved.

One stream concerns **coordination and governance**: agreements, roles, decision clarity, conflict handling, institutional discipline, and the integrity of process.

These streams must not be collapsed into one another.

Ecological ambition must not be financed by human burnout.

Human devotion must not be used to compensate for governance confusion.

Governance form must not be treated as valid if it has lost contact with lived reality.

We have learned that support becomes destructive when it arrives without discipline. We have learned that evidence matters, but that evidence must remain in relationship with life. We have learned that sequencing matters: foundation before expansion, viability before scale, clarity before new commitments.

We have learned that lawful structure is sometimes necessary, not because the deeper field is reducible to law, but because without lawful form, support cannot move cleanly, agreements cannot hold, and trust cannot scale beyond intimacy.

II. Constitutional Principles

From these learnings, we affirm the following principles.

1. ### Life-serving support

   All support received by the association shall serve the conditions of life, stewardship, and viable continuity. Support is not an instrument for extraction, prestige acquisition, disguised control, or financial speculation.

2. ### No ownership through support

   Financial support in itself does not confer ownership, profit participation, repayment rights, veto rights, steering rights, or hidden influence over the association, its partners, or its priorities. Membership and any governance rights associated with it are governed by the formal bylaws, not by the amount contributed.

3. ### No mixing of streams

   The association shall strive to read and govern distinct streams clearly: land and ecology, steward viability, and coordination and governance. A weakness in one stream shall not be hidden by apparent strength in another.

4. ### Viability before expansion

   Where steward viability or governance clarity declines into red conditions, expansion shall slow or pause. The restoration of viable conditions takes precedence over image, speed, and ambition.

5. ### Sequencing before escalation

   The association affirms foundation-first stewardship: water before scale, soil before image, documentation before inflation, role clarity before commitment expansion.

6. ### Transparency with boundaries

   Transparency is a duty, but not a spectacle. The association shall seek traceable, documented, and reviewable financial and governance practice while protecting sensitive human, legal, and field-specific information appropriately.

7. ### Documentation in service of life

   Documentation, dashboards, protocols, and evidence ledgers shall be used to improve legibility and continuity, not to replace human judgment, local knowledge, consent, or relational discernment.

8. ### Stewardship over branding

   Names, narratives, and public communication shall remain answerable to actual conditions in the field. The association shall resist premature scaling claims, symbolic inflation, and representational overreach.

9. ### Lawful vessel, living field

   The association acknowledges that legal form is necessary for receiving support, entering agreements, and carrying responsibility. Yet the legal vessel remains in service to a living field of stewardship rather than standing above it.

10. ### Relationship before abstraction

    The association affirms that observation, care, and governance begin in relationship: with place, with stewards, with the living world, and with the realities that emerge through repeated, embodied, situated attention.

III. How Support Shall Be Held

The association may receive support through donations, grants, memberships, patronage, strategic contributions, and other lawful forms of contribution consistent with its purpose. Such support shall be understood as purpose-bound stewardship support.

Support is received in order to strengthen legitimate stewardship tracks, including:

- land and ecological stewardship,
- cultural and knowledge work,
- coordination and partner infrastructure.

These are pathways for support, not three competing measures of success. Steward viability is a condition across them: land care, cultural and knowledge work, and coordination all depend on people having the livelihood, time, and capacity to carry the work. The distinction between resource destinations and condition readings is developed in GP22 §11.

Supporters may stand near the work in different ways. Some may offer small, bounded support. Some may become supporting members. Some may act as larger phase-bearing supporters or patrons. Some may become institutional partners. But no form of support in itself purchases governance authority, moral exemption, or claim over the field.

The association welcomes generosity.

It does not sell access to control.

Support may therefore be accompanied, where relevant, by documentation, role clarity, staged release, defined purposes, and other reasonable stewardship guardrails. The association may refuse support whose conditions are incompatible with its purpose, its integrity, or basic compliance obligations.

IV. On Patrons and Supporters

We honour those who help carry a field before it is fully recognized.

Some supporters stand close enough to feel the fragility of emergence and choose to help anyway. Such people may, in due course, be named patrons: not as owners, and not as sovereigns, but as those who help hold a threshold with responsibility, restraint, and trust.

In this framework, patronage does not mean social status.

It means deeper participation in the carrying of viable conditions.

But patronage remains bounded.

A patron does not buy the field.

A supporter does not own the stewards.

A contribution does not replace consent, governance, or local judgment.

Those who support this association are invited into relationship with a living process, not into possession of it.

V. Red, Yellow, Green, Unknown

The language of red, yellow, green, and unknown shall remain a discipline of truthful reading.

Red calls for pause, protection, or re-grounding.

Yellow calls for attention, adaptation, and care.

Green permits continuity, not complacency.

Unknown names a condition in which evidence or standpoint is insufficient for a responsible reading. It is not permission to proceed; serious or irreversible risk may require caution or pause.

This color logic shall not be used to shame persons, dramatize process, or oversimplify living realities. Its purpose is legibility. It exists so that real conditions may be seen in time, responded to proportionately, and held without concealment.

The association commits to reading these states across land, stewards, and governance alike. No single visible success shall excuse hidden depletion elsewhere.

VI. Commitment

We establish this constitutional ground because the passage from red to green requires more than goodwill.

It requires form.

It requires boundaries.

It requires honest reading.

It requires support that can move without distortion.

Spiralweb Stewardship Association exists to hold such conditions in lawful and practical form. Its purpose is to help ecological care, steward viability, governance clarity, and cultural documentation strengthen one another rather than split apart.

It exists so that support can enter lawfully, move transparently, and remain answerable to life. It exists so that emerging work across fields, partners, and places may be carried with greater coherence and less hidden cost.

This is our constitutional ground.

We do not claim completion.
We claim responsibility.

We do not claim green as a permanent state.
We commit to the discipline by which red may be read truthfully, yellow may be held carefully, and green may become possible again.